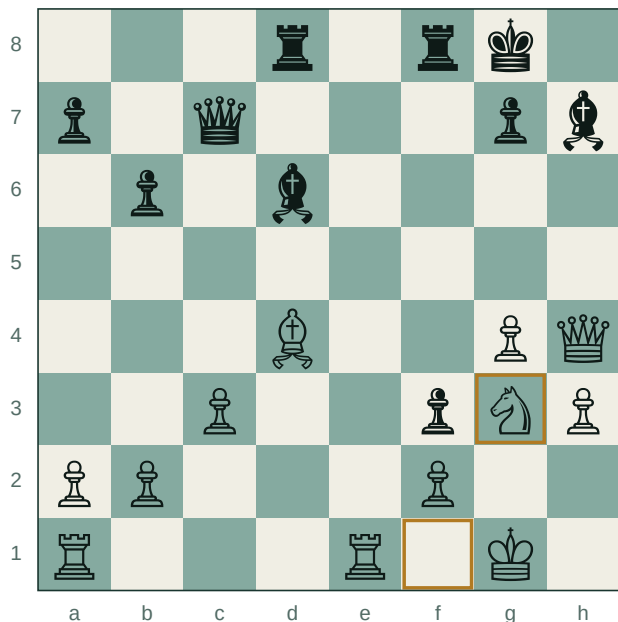


# Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 28

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 28.Ng3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**28...Bxg3 29. Qxg3 Qxg3+ 30. fxg3 Rxd4 31. cxd4 f2+**

**28...Bxg3** The bishop captures the knight on g3. The changed line means the rook on d8 attacks the bishop on d4. Recorded reply: **29.Qxg3**.

**29...Qxg3+** Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on g3. Recorded reply: **30.fxg3**.

**30...Rxd4** The rook captures the bishop on d4. Recorded reply: **31.cxd4**.

**31...f2+** Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From f2 it attacks king on g1 and rook on e1.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: -2:** the balance goes from -2 to -4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

**HOW TO LOOK**

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on h4. Check for tactical protection.